

Main Idea - Workbook 2

Transfer practice across informational, scientific, workplace, and literary contexts.

How to use this workbook

This workbook is transfer practice. Each text has a different context, but every question still asks you to identify the idea that best represents the text as a whole. Do not choose an answer just because it repeats a sentence from the passage.

Before you start

- Before reading the options, finish the sentence “The author mainly wants me to understand that...”
- Test the whole passage. A correct main idea should fit the beginning, middle, and end.
- Match certainty. If the author says may, suggests, or is testing, reject options that sound final or

absolute.

Text 1 - Shade at Bus Stops

A transit agency added shade structures at twelve bus stops after riders reported long waits in direct sun. During the first summer, temperature sensors under the structures recorded lower surface temperatures than nearby uncovered areas. Riders also reported greater comfort, although the structures did not reduce the actual air temperature. The agency plans to compare maintenance costs and rider feedback before expanding the project.

1. Which statement best expresses the central idea of the text?

- A. Shade structures can make waiting areas more comfortable, and the agency is evaluating whether to expand them. B. Bus riders should avoid traveling during the hottest part of the day. C. Surface temperature is always more important than air temperature. D. The agency installed exactly twelve structures because maintenance costs are low.

2. Which choice is too narrow to serve as the main idea?

- A. The project may improve rider comfort even though it does not change the air temperature. B. Sensors recorded lower surface temperatures under the shade structures. C. The agency is testing a comfort improvement before deciding whether to expand it. D. Shade structures are being evaluated using both physical measurements and rider feedback.

Text 2 - Restoring an Urban Stream

For decades, a small stream near the center of Brookhaven flowed through a concrete channel. The city recently removed part of the concrete, reshaped the banks, and planted native vegetation. Engineers expect the changes to slow stormwater and create habitat, but they are also monitoring whether the restored banks remain stable during heavy rain. The project is one part of a larger flood-management plan rather than a complete solution by itself.

3. Which statement best states the main point of the text?

- A. The city is restoring part of a stream to improve several functions while monitoring how well the design

performs. B. Concrete channels are the main cause of flooding in every city. C. Native plants are more attractive than concrete channels. D. The project will completely solve Brookhaven's flooding problems.

4. Which detail is most important to include when stating the main idea?

A. The stream is near the center of Brookhaven. B. The city removed some concrete and is testing whether the restored stream can support flood and habitat goals. C. Native vegetation was planted along the banks. D. Heavy rain sometimes occurs.

Text 3 - The Borrowed Camera

Leah borrowed her uncle's old camera for a weekend trip because she wanted photographs that looked different from phone pictures. At first she was frustrated that she had to adjust settings manually and could not immediately see whether each photo looked good. By the second day, she had started slowing down before each shot. When she returned the camera, she told her uncle that the most useful part had not been the equipment itself but learning to notice light and composition before pressing the shutter.

5. Which statement best expresses the central idea of the text?

A. Older cameras always take better photographs than phones. B. Using unfamiliar equipment helped Leah become more deliberate about how she took photographs. C. Leah should buy her own camera before her next trip. D. Manual camera settings are difficult to learn in one weekend.

6. Which choice is a true detail but not the main idea?

- A. Leah could not immediately see whether each photo looked good. B. The experience changed how Leah approached taking photographs. C. Leah learned to pay more attention before pressing the shutter. D. Working with the camera encouraged Leah to slow down and notice composition.

Text 4 - Flexible Lab Hours

A college chemistry department opened one laboratory room for supervised evening practice twice a week. The change was intended for students whose work or class schedules made daytime practice difficult. In the first month, attendance was modest but steady, and students used the sessions for both individual review and group preparation. The department will continue the trial through the semester before deciding whether the evening hours should become permanent.

7. Which statement best states the main point of the text?

- A. The chemistry department is testing evening lab access to give students another practice option before deciding whether to keep it. B. All students prefer studying chemistry in groups. C. Evening lab sessions are already more popular than daytime sessions. D. Students with jobs cannot attend daytime classes.

8. Which statement best preserves the author's level of certainty?

- A. Evening lab hours have proven to be the best way to improve chemistry grades. B. The evening sessions may provide useful access, but the department is still gathering evidence before making them permanent. C. The department will definitely expand evening hours next semester. D. Students rarely use the evening sessions.

Answer key and reasoning

1. **A.** A covers the project, its observed benefit, and the fact that expansion is still being evaluated. The other choices add claims the text does not support.
2. **B.** B is one important result, but it leaves out the broader purpose and evaluation of the project.
3. **A.** A reflects the restoration, multiple goals, and ongoing monitoring. B and D are too broad or absolute; C focuses on an idea the text does not discuss.
4. **B.** B combines the central action with the purpose of the project, making it much closer to the main idea than the isolated details.
5. **B.** B captures Leah's change from frustration to more careful observation. A and C are unsupported; D is only part of the experience.
6. **A.** A is a detail about the camera experience, while B, C, and D describe the larger idea developed through the passage.
7. **A.** A includes the purpose, the trial status, and the future decision. The other choices are unsupported or too broad.
8. **B.** B matches the trial nature of the program. The text reports early use but no final conclusion.

Mistake check

- If you chose a detail, ask whether your answer could describe only one sentence or paragraph.
- If you chose a broad claim, look for words such as all, always, best, or completely that the text does not

- justify.
- If two answers seem possible, choose the one that covers more of the passage without adding new information.